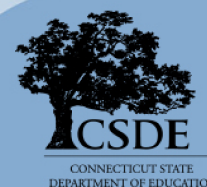


DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21

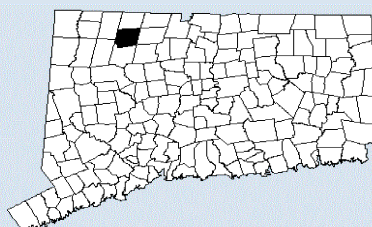


Explorations District

860-738-9070 • <http://www.ExplorationsCS.com>

District Information

Grade Range	9-12
Number of Schools/Programs	1
Enrollment	86
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,005
Total Expenditures ¹	\$1,767,479

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.

Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.4
Male	45	52.3	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.3
Asian	0	0.0	5.2
Black or African American	*	*	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	13	15.1	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	*	*	4.0
White	68	79.1	49.9
English Learners	0	0.0	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	64	74.4	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	33	38.4	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	10	25.6	*	*
Male	16	40.0	*	*
Black or African American	*	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*	0	*
White	18	28.1	*	*
English Learners	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	19	34.5	*	*
Students with Disabilities	12	41.4	*	*
District	26	32.5	*	*
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 21

Number of school-based arrests: 0

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Explorations District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	8.6
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	0.2
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	2.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	0.8
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	0.5
School Level	2.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	0.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	0.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	1.0
School Nurses	0.9
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	3.6

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.3
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	0	0.0	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	1	6.7	0.1
White	14	93.3	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	5.4	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	0	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	0	*	0	*
White	0	0.0	*	*
English Learners	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	0	0.0	*	*
Students with Disabilities	0	*	0	*
District	0	0.0	*	*
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A
Emotional Disturbance	N/A	N/A
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Explorations District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	N/A	N/A	1.1
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A	0.5
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A	5.8
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A	3.3
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A	1.9
All Disabilities	N/A	N/A	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	N/A	N/A	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	N/A	N/A	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$814,108	\$8,754	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$149,969	\$1,613	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$36,145	\$389	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$48,113	\$517	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$367,057	\$3,947	\$1,037
Central and other support services	.	.	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$328,606	\$3,533	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$23,482	\$435	\$1,159
Food services	.	.	\$21
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$151
Total	\$1,767,479	\$19,005	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$214,832	45.9	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	.	.	11.1
Other Salaries	\$148,632	31.8	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$40,067	8.6	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$16,655	3.6	5.4
Special Education Tuition	.	.	22.5
Supplies	\$7,299	1.6	0.5
Property Services	\$18,123	3.9	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	.	.	7.2
Equipment	\$21,937	4.7	0.2
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$467,546	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		26.5	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	0.0
State	65.1
Federal	4.1
Tuition & Other	30.8

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Explorations District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Explorations District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	N/A	N/A
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
English Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	15	*
Students with Disabilities	17	*
District	31	54.8
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	75.0	*	*
Male	*	*	*
Black or African American	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino	*	0	*
White	73.2	*	*
English Learners	N/A	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	72.2	*	*
Students with Disabilities	*	0	*
District	72.9	*	*
State	85.0		36.0

³ College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴ Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	*	*
Male	*	*
Black or African American	*	N/A
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	*	*
English Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	*	*
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Explorations District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	32.5%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	36.7%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	8.3%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	10.4%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		.	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		54.8%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		78.3%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		.	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		57.5%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	.	78.3%	.	9.8%	N

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Explorations District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

During the 2020-21 school year, students attended Explorations from 21 different towns. School staff found many students had academic deficiencies in basic skills. We used classroom formative tests, STAR 360, and CCSS aligned math assessments to identify students in need of additional support. Each student had a data binder where benchmark testing was summarized and these binders were available to teachers as they planned lessons, created IEP goals, and created Focus Areas. Teachers revised curriculum and planned lessons to better differentiate to meet the needs of all students. Students showing a weakness in Math received increased Math Lab support in addition to their scheduled math class. In data-team meetings, staff discussed student specific needs and planned how best to accommodate them in the classroom. We continued an initiative called "The A-Team challenge," (although modified to accommodate for the hybrid/cohort model) designed to improve attendance, academic performance, student behavior, and proficiency on benchmark tests. We hoped to continue the attendance challenge, where students with the highest attendance rates would earn a trip at the end of the school year. We were forced to cancel our 2021 trip due to Covid-19.

To curb student truancy, we continued a policy where parents were contacted daily by our school nurse or an automated system when students were absent. The contact with parents allowed us to have important conversations around attendance. The school executive director, assistant principal, social worker, and nurse continued to be members of the school attendance committee. The group revised the process to identify student truancy; these improvements included earlier intervention strategies, revised letters, student conferences, parent meetings, and referrals to outside agencies. The social worker and assistant principal also made home visits to offer support and solutions to students with poor attendance. The social worker addressed a range of social-emotional issues, and worked closely with families, teachers, and administration to implement strategies and work on goals related to student IEPs and other overall social-emotional needs. The school nurse and assistant principal also held weekly academic meetings to offer support to students and to find ways to improve their grades in the classroom.

We continued our commitment to supporting the family's role in the education of our students. Parents helped with school fundraising activities and with after school activities such as the school kayak club. We continued the use of a "Parent Portal," which allowed parents and students to check grades in all classes in real time, providing transparency and increased communication between parents and staff. We did not hold our traditional school activities due to Covid-19, but hopefully we can resume these activities next year. We held a variety of virtual parent meetings and conferences and continued to work with families to ensure that students had access to necessary resources, technology and connectivity. Parents could come to the school building to pick up necessary supplies. When transportation posed a challenge for parents, administrators and staff delivered required items to student homes. Staff regularly communicated with parents to offer support and guidance on helping their students.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The school provides opportunities for teachers and students to gain awareness of diversity, differences, and personal experiences. In the classroom, our curriculum encourages discussion of different cultures and backgrounds. This multi-cultural lens exposes students to ideas where they may form personal connections and where they can reflect on acquired knowledge. The school is welcoming of all races and sexual orientations; students are free to be who they want to be and are accepted by the community.

The location of Explorations in the northwestern corner of the state limits more integrated communities from taking advantage of our school. We place ads on local radio stations, and in local newspapers. We were unable to travel to other schools in 2020-21, as we typically do those visits in the springtime. During the visits, representatives from Explorations make presentations so that we can introduce our program to a wider audience. To help our relative geographic isolation, we provide transportation with three bus stops in Torrington for students at a significant expense to our budget. A lack of transportation from other towns prevents students from more diverse areas from attending Explorations.

Typically, our Friday activities offer unique opportunities for our students. We canceled the activities in the Fall of 2020, but resumed in March 2021. Adventure Education takes the place of the standard physical education classes. Activities include rock climbing, ice skating, snowshoeing, biking, kayaking, and hiking. Many students from lower socio-economic backgrounds and who are geographically isolated may have never had the opportunity to participate in these types of activities; for some, these experiences have provided a lifelong interest. Unfortunately, we had to cancel our Unpaid Experiential Learning Program (UELP) for the entire year. All juniors and seniors were required to participate in an internship designed to give them experience in a future field of employment. When not on Adventure Education, Freshmen and Sophomores experience "Academic Enrichment " including guidance, health, fitness, and remedial / enrichment activities.

Since the 2013-2014 school year our minority population increased from a low of 9.6% in June of 2014 to 20.9% in October

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Explorations District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

As a one building charter school, Explorations allocates all resources in one high school building. The proposed budget of our school is created in late spring by administrators and the board finance committee, voted on by the Governing Board, and is based on full enrollment and funding from the SDE. Adjustments are made after the October 1 count as needed. Grant writing is the greatest supplement to our budget, and we use grants for student and staff need areas. Our current 1003(g) SIG grant has allowed the school to do the following items over the past five years: expand technology in the school, provide wilderness therapy to students, provide support in the area of post-secondary transition, hire a building sub to provide staff release time, provide summer and school-year enrichment activities, expand that Graphic Design department through the purchase of digital cameras and iMacs, and purchase Smart Boards for classrooms. Parents are also essential to aiding our overhead costs. They often provide the school with a variety of products, including paper towels, toilet paper, classroom supplies, and copy paper. Our solar panel project, completed with grant funds in 2019, continue